



Active Transportation & the Built Environment

Accessibility, Design, and Planning

Fall 2026

Maryam Hosseini

City & Regional Planning



Module I Wrap up



What key concepts or ideas stood out to you in Module I?"
(Enter words or short phrases, anything that stuck with you.)





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Accessibility evaluation of land-use and transport strategies: review and research directions

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Overview



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A framework for asking what an accessibility
measure actually represents and what it leaves out.



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Measures that are easy to calculate and communicate often represent accessibility poorly; measures that represent accessibility better are usually harder to calculate, interpret, and communicate.



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Infrastructure-based measures



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Location-based measures



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Person-based measures



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Utility-based measures

Calculated accessibility vs. experienced accessibility

The 2004 framework is overwhelmingly about accessibility **that analysts can calculate from transport, land use, temporal, and individual variables.**

More recent work tries to distinguish:
calculated accessibility from **perceived accessibility.**

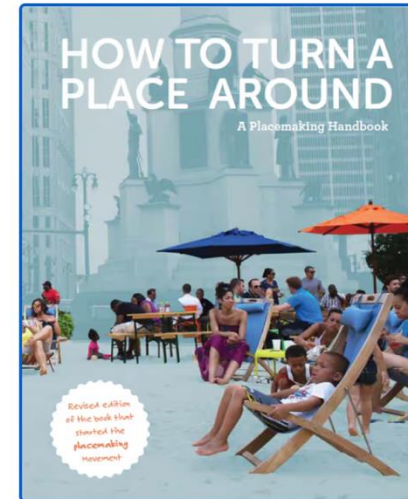
A transit model might show that everyone can reach 25 grocery stores within 30 minutes on foot. Does this always hold?

Eleven Principles for Creating Great Community Places

English | [Español](#)

Effective public spaces are extremely difficult to accomplish, because their complexity is rarely understood. As William (Holly) Whyte said, "It's hard to design a space that will not attract people. What is remarkable is how often this has been accomplished."

In our placemaking handbook [*How to Turn a Place Around*](#), Project for Public Spaces identified 11 key elements in transforming public spaces into vibrant community places, whether they're parks, plazas, public squares, streets, sidewalks or the myriad other outdoor and indoor spaces that have public uses in common. This was a key milestone in our history, as this book helped to launch and define the [Placemaking](#) movement.



This is an excerpt from [How to Turn a Place Around](#), (Second Edition).

Overview

Problem Formulation and Fairness

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Overview

Problem Formulation and Fairness

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A real-world objective does not arrive already expressed as a measurable statistical problem. People have to decide what the objective means, select targets, find proxies, and adapt those choices to whatever data are available. Those decisions are discretionary and can have ethical consequences before any model is fitted.

How Proxies Become the Goal

Why did this particular operationalization become “accessibility” in the first place?

If one operationalizes accessibility as:

Number of grocery stores reachable within a 15 minute walk.

There are already many decisions embedded in that apparently simple variable:

Accessibility becomes **reachable opportunities**.

Opportunities become **grocery stores**.

Reachable becomes **15 minutes**.

Walking becomes whatever the routing network recognizes as traversable.